Dickson Rutha

Software Engineer · Head of Systems

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Tanzania

I'm a software engineer who builds software that businesses rely on every day. Over the last eight years I've built web systems, mobile apps and WhatsApp chatbots for companies in Tanzania, Uganda and Malawi, and I've led the projects and teams behind them. Today I'm Head of Systems at ChemCheemi Africa, where I look after our IoT platform and AI work, and I also build software for Ecowater International.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Systems · ChemCheemi Africa — 2023 – Present

- Responsible for all of the company's systems, from planning and architecture through to delivery and support.
- Built TapCloud, our IoT platform for connecting and monitoring devices remotely.
- Added AI features to our products and internal workflows.
- Integrated our systems with banks, mobile money and SMS providers.
- Work with management to decide what we build next and make sure it gets delivered.

Software Engineer · Ecowater International, Dodoma — 2023 – Present

- Build and maintain the software behind water ordering, deliveries, retail and payments.
- Part of the team that built Ecowater's new cloud system for Uganda and Malawi, including integrations with local banks and mobile money providers.
- Built an Android app for our new stores that sends store data to the cloud.
- Built Mr. Majik, a WhatsApp bot customers use to order water, and MajikDrive, the app our drivers use for deliveries.
- Built ESMS for managing stores remotely and EFA, the cashier system for water card top-ups.

Technical Team Member · Gasify Energy

- Connected our meters to our cloud so meter data comes in automatically.

Freelance Web & Software Developer — 2019 – Present

- Design and build websites and custom systems for businesses and individuals, from first conversation to launch.

MITz Kits & StadiSpace Manager · MITz Group, Mwanza — 2018 – 2023

- Managed the company's main projects and the teams working on them.
- Sent monthly financial and technical reports to senior management.
- Started student programmes and designed STEM kits for hands-on learning.

OTHER PROJECTS

EcoPlus · WhatsApp chatbot that lets university students register, check timetables and vote.

Bookify · Hotel and apartment booking system with room availability.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES
PHP, JavaScript, Dart, SQL

FRAMEWORKS
Laravel, CodeIgniter, Flutter

WEB & DATA
HTML, CSS, MySQL, REST APIs, system design, Excel

INTEGRATIONS
Bank APIs, mobile money, SMS gateways, WhatsApp API

AI & IOT
AI integration, chatbots, IoT platforms

TOOLS
Git, VS Code, Android Studio

STRENGTHS

Team leadership

Project and delivery management

Explaining technical things to non-technical people

Owning a project from start to finish

Problem solving under tight deadlines

EDUCATION

BSc in Software Engineering
University of Dodoma, 2014 – 2018

ACSEE (A-Level)
Galanos Secondary School, 2012 – 2014

CSEE (O-Level)
Hai Day Secondary School, 2008 – 2011

LANGUAGES

English (fluent)

Swahili (native)

References available on request.